The Mountainside

A Publication of the Coolfont Mountainside Association

Autumn, 2002 Volume 5 Issue 1

NEW!! www.coolfontmountainside.org

Autumn On The Mountainside

By Jackson Bain

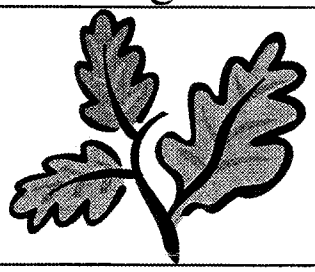
Stop what you're doing, get in your car—right now—and come to Coolfont! If you live here, put this newsletter on the table and walk outside! It's autumn!

According to thoroughly unscientific polls of CMA members, autumn is the hands-down winner of favorite season of the year. And why not? Even with a prolonged spring and summer drought, the colors on the mountainside and in the coves and valleys in our area promise to be delightful - though perhaps short-lived - this year.

Still, there is much to do and to savor this autumn. Here is a partial list of nice things to do right here in our area to celebrate this most colorful of seasons (with thanks to the Berkeley Springs tourism website):

Saturday, Oct. 19 at 10 a.m.: Local naturalist Kris O'Brien (Cabins by O'Brien) will lead a nature walk through her 80-acre wooded preserve. Free, open to the public and not strenuous but terrain may be rough. Call for directions, 304-754-9128.





Saturday, Oct. 26 at 10 a.m.: Join Kris O'Brien in front of the Berkeley Springs State Park gift shop for a tree identification walk around the park.

Following the tour at 11 a.m., just cross Fairfax Street and learn about homeopathic plants and medicines from your host Joe Lillard at Homeopathy Works.

Clear cool nights make great stargazing! The next Star Show lecture features Mark Klosinsky from the Jet Propulsion Laboratory's Solar System Ambassadors program, speaking about the "Mysteries of Stonehenge." Saturday, Oct. 26, 7 p.m. at the Ice House. Free and open to the public.

Fall foliage migratory bird walk will leave from the Treetops Lobby at Coolfont on Sunday, Oct. 20 and Oct. 27, at 9:15 a.m. The walk is open to the public but a $5 fee will be charged. Kris O'Brien will lead the hour-long walk.

Nuts for Clean Water: Growing Native is a volunteer-led effort to supply much-needed native hardwood tree seeds to state nurseries for use in river and streamside reforestation efforts. Waterside vegetation is important because it filters pollutants from run-off, prevents erosion, keeps the water temperature cooler, and provides food and habitat for animals. Growing Native educates people about the important connection between land use and water quality. Check out the new Growing Native website at www.growingnative.org to learn more about this exciting project and how you can 'Get Nuts for Clean Water'. If you have questions, contact Rob Carey, Growing Native Coordinator, coordinator@growingnative.org.

BOARD MEETINGS and POTLUCK DINNER SCHEDULE

October 19:

Board: **10:00 a.m.**
CMA Office

Potluck: **7:00 p.m.**
BARN

November 9:

Board: **10:00 a.m.**
Place to be determined

Potluck:
7:00 p.m.
Place to be determined

December 14:

Board: **10:00 a.m.**
Place to be determined

Potluck: **7:00 p.m.**
Place to be determined

Jaunary 11:

Board: **10:00 a.m.**
Place to be determined

Potluck: **7:00 p.m.**
Place to be determined

COME TO THE CMA BOARD MEETINGS AND THE POTLUCK DINNERS!

Want to Know What's Going On Faster?

If you would like to receive notification of monthly board meetings, potlucks and other CMA information via e-mail, please send your e-mail address to:

Joan Bradfield, CMA Secretary at :

jbradfield1@juno.com.

HOST A POTLUCK OR BOARD MEETING!

Joan Bradfield, board liaison to the Social Committee, is looking for hosts for CMA's Board meetings and / or Potluck Dinners!
Please let Joan know if you would be able to pitch in and help with hosting!

jbradfield1@juno.com
or:
(301) 984-9657

Recreation Committee Update: Planning for the Tennis Courts

TENNIS

Rick Picardi is heading up an ad hoc group researching options for fixing up our tennis courts. The group will present results of its research to the board in a few months. If you would like to help with this project, please contact Rick.

Several CMA members mentioned at the annual meeting that they would like to know who else plays tennis so they can find partners when they get the itch for a game. If you're a tennis player, please contact me and I'll compile a list of such folk, which can be shared through the next newsletter.

TRAILS

Carroll and Phyllis Yingling have agreed to take the lead in checking on and maintaining our trails this year. They hope to do some initial work this fall. If you'd like to help, please contact Carroll or Phyllis.

Marie Barrett,
Recreation Committee Chair

THE PRESIDENT'S COLUMN

Water and Weather

A couple of things caught my eye in the Oct. 2 *Morgan Messenger.* One is a letter to the editor by a citizen irate over the Berkeley Springs water situation. Just a week earlier it was revealed that the town's water system was in crisis, could not meet the community's need for water, and had to get emergency relief from the town of Hancock, Md. Hancock came to the rescue but the citizen, citing the admission that the town's antiquated water system loses as much as 40% of its water, wonders why Berkeley Springs let the problem get so bad.

The letter writer (whose sex cannot be told from the way the letter is signed) observes that if the town had spent some money to fix its leaky system a lot more than what has been wasted so far could have been saved: "Someone should be held accountable for such a waste of natural resources and the inconvenience to which the community is experiencing now."

I find the citizen's logic impeccable. Here on the mountainside we have been conveying the same message to the developer of our T section. To resume the story, we discovered a major leak in the T section water system earlier this year while it was, in effect, still under warranty. We brought the leak to the attention of Sam Ashelman, whose company, Coolfont Development Company, had the system installed. To his credit, Mr. Ashelman acknowledged responsibility and promised to

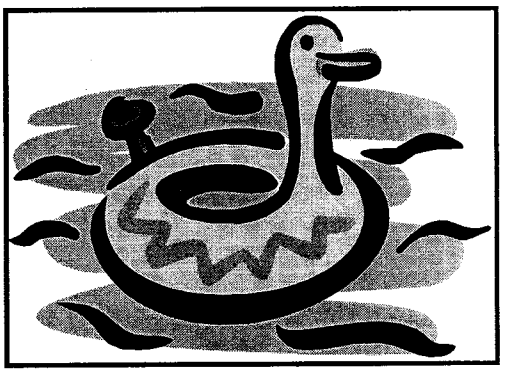
(Con't.- Pg 5)

The Water Column

By Elmer Broxson,
CMA Water Operator

Our Operations Manager, John Hobday, along with Dwain Place and I attended the September meeting of the West Virginia Rural Water Association, held annually in Canaan Valley. Among the three of us, we attended over a dozen training sessions during the three-day conference. The sessions ranged in topic from "Protection Planning after 9/11" to "Tort Liabilities", and included such exciting topics as "Turbidity" and "Ultrasonic Flow Metering". We were asked by the CMA Board to find out how we could locate, measure and protect both the quality and quantity of the aquifers which supply our two wells.

Dealing with the Board request first, we were told where to find the data needed to locate and measure the aquifers (the U.S. Geological Survey, the W.V. Department of Health, etc,) and that we were more likely than any other source in our valley to contaminate the aquifers with our nine existing septic fields. The measure we use to prevent this from happening is the state-mandated continuous chlorination of our waste supply, which we practice.



From other sessions we learned that, given our small system that serves only about 115 houses, it would not be economical:

1) to monitor our reservoirs with telephone or radio systems,
2) to install touch-read water meters, and
3) to adopt another disinfection means other than the chlorine we now use.

In a lawsuit-happy society, the session on torts suggested several steps to best defend against, if not prevent, legal problems: keeping good records, keeping equipment repaired, keeping staff well-trained, keeping customers well informed and selecting contractors with care.

From our present perspective, the greatest potential increases in our water systems expense, due to significant additional monitoring requirements, are two:

1) if we should have more than 25 full-time resident houses, we change from a "non-community, transient" category to a "community" level, and
2) if our aquifers are deemed to be "under the influence" of surface water, rather than strictly ground water as they are today.

DACC Activities: Keeping our Standards, Protecting Our Investment

By Jim Thompson, DACC Chair

As I reported at the annual meeting, it has been a very busy year for DACC. New houses have been completed on Q-8 and T-2, new houses are under construction on A-2, H-1, K-1, K-2, Q-7 and T-8, and additional new house applications are expected soon.

Did you know?...

That you are required to get DACC approval not only when building a new house, but also when making external modifications to your house or property? This includes additions, repainting or restaining of your home, adding walls or fences, new or replacement decks, major landscaping, and certain tree cutting and trimming.
The Board has directed that DACC may not process any building or renovation applications if the owner is arrears in payments to CMA (ie. Water & Sewer bills or annual assessments)?

The Board has directed that any new or renovated driveways that require culverts must have 15" corrugated galvanized steel culverts to effect proper drainage and resist damage due to heavy vehicles driving over them?

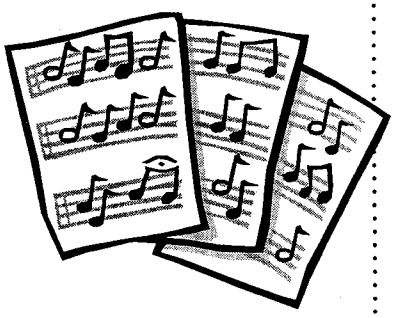
The Board has declined approving the placement of satellite dishes on common land. Instead, they are reviewing options for CMA sponsored cable or satellite TV installations.

Coolfont Foundation for the Arts

Fall Calendar of Events

10/19/02 - The Borowsky Family presenting The Alexander Blume Jazz Ensemble from Eisenach Germany - "American and German Jazz Music" at the Treetop House, 8:30pm.

11/02/02 - Pianist, Thomas Pandolfi. Critics and audiences alike are consistent in their praise for Thomas Pandolfi's dramatic, yet sensitive style of playing. The Manor House, 8:30pm



11/09/02 - Harp & Fool. Sue Richard, harp and Mark Jaster, mime present stories through harp and mime. At the Treetop House, 8:30pm.

11/23/02 - Bob Peake, outstanding local photographer and world traveler will entertain with a talk and slide show of images from around the world. 8:30pm in the Treetop House - Capen Room.

11/30/02 - Pianist, Peter Basquin, for his annual Thanksgiving weekend concert at the Manor House, 8:30pm.

12/19-21/02 - Maddie McNeil, gifted singer and dulcimer player at the Treetop House, 8:30pm.

12/28/02 - The M Street Brass Quintet with a holiday concert for the entire family. In the Treetop House, 8:30pm.

IS YOUR COOLFONT HOME READY FOR WINTER?

By John Hobday
CMA Operations Manager

As Winter approaches, it is time to look over your home on the mountainside to insure it is secure. A few simple checks can save everyone time and money in repairs.

- Shut foundation vents for the winter.
- Disconnect water hose from outside spigot.
- Turn off main water valve when leaving you house if it is not a rental. Drain water from the lowest faucet in the house.
- Toilet tank cleaners (such as those that are dropped in tanks) will distort the rubber flapper in the water tank and cause them to leak.
- Rental homes or homes with small children should keep mouse poison where the children can not find it.
- Install outside sign or sticker saying there is an alarm system even if you do not have a system. It will make people think twice about breaking into your house.
- Install a security bar ("Charlie bar") in the center of all sliding glass doors. It takes only a few minutes to remove a stick or broom handle that is put at the bottom of the door.
- If a house is taken off the CRI rental program, change the locks on your house.
- Install a timer for a small lamp or radio near a window in a bedroom.

(President's Column, con't.)
fix the problem. A temporary measure was taken but we're still waiting for a permanent solution. We have been patient, so far.

The second interesting item in the *Messenger* is the weather forecast - actually, 2 weather forecasts. An editorial announces that the official forecast is a Warm and Dry winter. That, it is reported, is what the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA) predicts. In other words, mild temperature and more drought.

But on the same page the newspaper displays a map with the forecast of *The Old Farmer's Almanac for 2003*. It predicts a Cold and Wet winter beginning with a snowstorm in later November.

I guess the rest of us are on our own. As I write this, there has been a gentle, steady rain for 2 days. How about a Mild and Wet one?

Richard F. Kaufman

WALKING THE ROADS WITH A DRAINAGE EXPERT

By Lon Dring,
Chairman - Roads Committee

On September 18, Elmer Broxson and I walked the Mountainside roads with Rebecca McCloud of the U.S. Soil Conservation Service, an expert on drainage. Until the water running off our mountain is not undermining our roads and overwhelming our ditches and culverts, road repairs will never be lasting.

Ditches should be broad and flat in order to accept the water and to allow it to sink into the ground. Our culverts should be larger, and we need to need keep the area leading into the culvert open and spacious and to build grass or rock headwalls in some places. We need a center crown in our roads for better runoff. Shoulders need to be stabilized. Dips are needed where driveways come down to meet a road.

Ms. McCloud expects to send out other folks from her office, more carefully to examine the situation, to take pictures, and make recommendations. She will put together a report for us.

Changes and Corrections to 2002-03 Membership Directory

E-4
Coolfont Development Corporation & Eric Ashelman
3621 Cold Run Valley Road
Berkeley Springs, WV 25411

Q-7
Ed & Jean Haywood
7 Ridgecliff Court
Kingsville, MD 21087
Home telephone: 410-592-7744
Work telephone: 410-935-7665
Work FAX 1-866-422-1885
E-mail : ed@edhaywood.com

I-4 Delete: Greenblat
Insert: James Applebaum
Laurie Mufson
300 E. Seminary Street
Mercersburg, PA 17236
717-328-2471

Add for **N-6**: Terry and Marsha Moore
1346 Washington Dr.
Annapolis, MD 21403;
email: TMoore9261@aol.com

Add for **Q-3**: Denzil and Marilyn Prichard, 2357 Bell Branch Rd., Gambrills, MD 21054, phone 301-261-6187

Kathy Steinberg-E-mail address: knewman@umm.edu

Michael Barrett-E-mail address: mbarrett@liuna.org

Ken Sachs/Judy Grasso-E-mail address: kfsachs@comcast.net

Mark Borinsky-E-mail address: mborinsk@jhmi.edu

Remove Travis Clark

Bob and Kelly Corbey (new address)
604 Manakee St.
Rockville, MD 20850

Gini Sweet **(D-7)** has gotten married (Congratulations!)
New Name: Gini Temple
Address: P.O. Box 1576
Ashburn, VA 20146
Tel: 703-771-6570 (work)
304-258-7901

Also: Sales to be closed soon - Q-4 Bowers